



Assessment-taking strategies

As you progress through this program, you will complete graded assessments at the end of each module. Assessments are a useful signpost for you to note your progress or identify concepts or skills you need to review. However, assessments can sometimes feel overwhelming.

Approaching them with a strategy can make them more manageable. To help you do just that, this reading will give you a list of tips and strategies you can use to set yourself up for success and feel confident in your ability to overcome these challenges.

Before taking an assessment:

- Review your notes, the videos, the readings, and the most recent glossary to refresh yourself on the content.
- Find a picture of something or an object that makes you feel happy. For example, you might look at a photograph of a beautiful beach or a peaceful forest when you feel overwhelmed.

During the assessment:

- Review the test before filling in answers. Remember to check your work before you click Submit.
- Answer the easy questions first; skip the ones you don't know the answer to right away.
- For multiple choice questions, focus on eliminating the wrong answers first.
- Read each question twice. There are often clues that are easy to miss the first time.
- Remember to slow down and trust your knowledge. You probably know more than you give yourself credit for.
- Take some time during the assessment to rest for a few seconds. This can really help calm your nerves.

If you start to feel anxious:

- Spell your name backwards or do an easy math problem. This brings you back to the frontal lobe of your brain, which helps you recall information more easily.

- Focus on calm, steady breathing.
- Visualize success.

Before you submit the assessment:

- Check your work, but be confident. Sometimes people change correct answers because they feel wrong, but they're actually right. Your first instinct is usually correct.

After you submit the assessment:

- Take a deep breath and give yourself some positive feedback. Regardless of your score, your effort was a worthwhile learning experience!
- Remember, you can retake the assessment if you aren't satisfied with your score.